

OE3C Planning Meeting

Date: 27 Oct 2025

Location: Online (Recording can be found [here](#))

Time: 10:00–11:05 AM

Attendees: Lyllian Corbin, Alex Wilder, Katherine Yagi, Kiyoko Gotanda, Reem Mahamoud, Madelaine Legault, Rasa Khosrowshahli, Sarah Hein, Nicholas Benton, Matthew Summerville

Minutes by: Lyllian Corbin

Kiyoko introduced everyone to the meeting

- This will be the first time the Brock is hosting OE3C in 20 years
- Round-table introductions for the OE3C team

Alex led the following discussion points for the remainder of the meeting (written as bullet points)

- General notes:
 - o Lauren is not available to speak on the logo
 - o Lyllian will have a Secretary role on the team
 - o Any OE3C-related emails should have the OE3C email cc'd as well
 - o Alex is looking into possible options to get funding from BUSU
 - o OE3C Github: <https://github.com/photopidge/OE3C-Archives>
 - o Elena Genkin can help circulate communications and calls for volunteers if subcommittee leads need more volunteers on board
- Discussion on current theme for the conference:
 - o “Coexisting with nature – life in the Niagara escarpment biosphere”
 - The team is on board with the idea
 - Kiyoko brought up the concern that presenters might feel pressured to fit their research into that theme
 - We might cut out the Niagara escarpment half and keep “Coexisting with nature”
 - Include “harmony” in theme title?
 - Madelaine suggested to include decolonisation in the theme some way
 - Nick suggested the theme include “living within nature”
 - We will circle back to this discussion at a later time

- Code of conduct
 - A general OE3C committee code of conduct will be drafted for all organising members to abide by
- Trello tool – Link available on Teams
 - Progress tracker we will use for conference planning
 - Useful for to-do lists and project organisation
 - People can use their personal or Brock emails to join the OE3C Trello board
 - **Agenda items need to be added on the Trello board by the Sunday before each meeting**
 - **Documents should be shared to the OE3C Teams group only in the Files channel**
 - Links to documents can be posted in the respective Teams channel afterwards
- Accommodations
 - Expected conference attendance can range from 75 to 175 guests
 - Accommodations are not possible on campus
 - Residences will not be cleaned in time after exams are finished
 - Four points hotel (near Lofts)
 - Will provide a block of 50 rooms at \$160/night
 - We can add more if rooms get filled up
 - Enough space for 4 guests so this is option suitable for groups traveling together
 - IHG Group hotels
 - Alex is in contact with manager
 - Air BNB options?
 - A potential list could be given to attendees so they can choose an option close to Brock's campus
- Sub-committees & Leads
 - Advertising, Coms, and promotions
 - **Lead: TBD**
 - Webmaster: Rasa K.
 - Social media manager: Matthew S.
 - Fundraising and finance
 - Lead: Alex W.
 - Budget lead: Sarah H
 - Outings and Socials
 - Lead: Madelaine L. (assisting)
 - Abstracts, schedules, and programs
 - Lead: Nicholas B.

- Registration Lead: Reem M.
 - Workshops, Speakers, Seminars
 - Lead: Nicholas B.
 - **Keynote Lead: TBD**
 - Bookings and records
 - Lead: Lyllian C.
- Amending discussion on logo because Lauren is absent
- Timeline
 - 10 Mar 2026: 50% hotel rooms released; tentative abstract deadline (possible soft deadline)
 - 29 Mar 2026: 100% hotel rooms released; abstract registration closes
 - **TBD: Attendee registration closes?**
- Keynote speaker
 - Need one speaker for each E (Ecology, Evolution, Ethology)
 - List of ideas is available on Teams
 - **Keynote lead will research and choose topic choices for each E and report back at the next meeting**
 - Please include speaker's website + contact info
 - Madelaine L. suggested someone from the Environmental Sustainability Research Centre (ESRC) to bring more light to research in the Niagara region
 - There is someone from Vineland doing research on crop adaptation
 - We need to confirm the keynote speakers as soon as possible
 - We have the budget to fly someone in, so we can reach out internationally
 - The team is on board with having an additional speaker that is a public talk
 - Could work with someone from Vineland and have a tour afterwards
- Workshops, outings, and socials
 - Ideas list available on Teams: under Files and Docs > Outings and Socials > Ideas doc (post links to documents under the outings channel) – **ideas need to be added before Oct 31st**
 - Outings ideas
 - Niagara Falls passes (Harry's idea on Trello)
 - CCOVI tours
 - Wine-tasting from the wine library
 - Tour of the Glenridge Quarry

- VPMI
 - Vineland
 - Watering Can
 - Socials ideas
 - Margarita's bar
 - Isaac's is building a new centre, so they will not be open
 - Banquet
 - Need to pre-sell tickets so we don't lose money if people decide not to come
- Questions/general discussion
- Announcements need to go out asap
 - Alex's cell for contact: 519-965-4619
 - Justin Steepe has offered to help with website stuff
 - Twee is marketing contact (*Lyllian: I think I misheard her name...*)
 - Alex will reach out to Cindy (Indigenous centre) to hold an opening ceremony
 - CRN 527 is booked for every Monday for OE3C meetings and work periods

Meeting was adjourned at 11:05 AM.